THE RIGHTS OF OTHERS

The Heavy Responsibility of the Journey to the Hereafter

Settling accounts and seeking release before the day when dinar and dirham are of no use

Subject: The material and moral dimensions of the rights of others, the reckoning in the Hereafter, and the ways of settling accounts and seeking release	**Date:** Friday, 30 October 2026
Prepared by: the imam and preacher	**Audience:** A multigenerational congregation living in Europe
Main sources: The Qur'an, the hadith corpus, and the sources of fiqh and fatwa	**Duration:** About 40–45 minutes; adapted to the congregation

◆ Aim of the sermon and guidance

To help the congregation see that the rights of others are not merely "consuming someone's money"; to remind them that others have rights in property, honour, speech, labour and public resources; to awaken, not fear, but an awareness of accountability and a resolve to settle accounts and seek release. The key sentence: **A right owed to another is not lifted until it is returned to its owner or the owner releases us from it; whoever does not settle it today will pay with their good deeds on the day when dinar and dirham are of no use.**

THE 45-MINUTE PULPIT TIMELINE

Stage	Page	Time	Emphasis
Opening and the bond of the heart	**2**	**4 min**	"Do you release him from what he owed you?", asked at the funeral
Foundation: the trust and justice	**3–4**	**7 min**	The trust covers everything; justice
Material rights of others	**5–6**	**8 min**	Measure and weight; debt, wages and one's word
Moral rights of others: the tongue	**7–8**	**7 min**	Mockery, backbiting, slander and false accusation; the incident of the great slander (ifk)
Social media	**9**	**4 min**	Four questions before sharing
True bankruptcy	**10**	**5 min**	The hadith of the bankrupt; the right of the hornless sheep
Family, neighbours, work; the public	**11–12**	**6 min**	Family and inheritance; misappropriation of public property (ghulul), keeping one's covenants
Settling accounts and seeking release; the closing	**13–14**	**4 min**	The pledge of settling accounts and seeking release; the congregation's supplication

NOTE FOR THE PREACHER — Guidance for use in the pulpit

The subject touches consciences: unpaid debts, injustices over inheritance, quarrels that have lasted for years… **Do not single anyone out of the congregation as "that tradesman" or "this family";** use the language of "all of us". Read the hadith of the bankrupt not to frighten but to awaken, and always end with the way out, that is, with the settling of accounts and seeking release on page 13. Relate the narrations that carry a note of weakness with the words "it is narrated that".

If time runs short, summarise page 9 with the four questions; keep pages 2, 6, 10 and 13. Present the examples of life in Europe on page 12 (tax, benefits, ticket) as reminders, not accusations.

SEVEN KEY CONCEPTS

Concept	Meaning and its place in the sermon
The rights of others (huquq al-'ibad)	People's material and moral rights, such as their life, property, honour and dignity; they lapse only when paid to their owner or when the owner's consent is obtained.
The trust (amana)	Everything left in our care in confidence: belongings, duty, word, secrets, health, children and public resources.
Backbiting and slander	Backbiting (ghiba) is mentioning a person in their absence with a trait they would dislike; slander (buhtan) is attributing to them what they do not have.
Ghulul	Secretly setting aside for oneself a part of the common property one holds by virtue of a duty; today, reaching for public resources.
Public right	Property and resources that belong to the community: taxes, transport, social benefits, shared spaces.
The bankrupt (muflis)	Not a person without money, but one whose good deeds are distributed to those entitled and who is loaded with their sins.
Settling accounts and seeking release (helallesme)	Paying what is owed to its owner, or bringing the owner to agree willingly and release the right.

OPENING: NOTHING GOES UNREQUITED

SUPPLICATION — Praise, blessings and the opening supplication

الْحَمْدُ لِلَّهِ رَبِّ الْعَالَمِينَ، وَالصَّلَاةُ وَالسَّلَامُ عَلَى رَسُولِنَا مُحَمَّدٍ وَعَلَى آلِهِ وَصَحْبِهِ أَجْمَعِينَ

قَالَ رَبِّ اشْرَحْ لِي صَدْرِي ۝ وَيَسِّرْ لِي أَمْرِي ۝ وَاحْلُلْ عُقْدَةً مِّن لِّسَانِي ۝ يَفْقَهُوا قَوْلِي

Praise belongs to Allah, Lord of the worlds. Blessings and peace be upon our Prophet Muhammad, upon his family and upon all his Companions. Moses said: "My Lord! Grant me ease of heart. Make my task easy for me. Loosen the knot from my tongue, so that they may understand my words well."

[Praise: al-Fatiha, 1:2. Blessings: free wording of the supplication. Supplication: Ta-Ha, 20:25–28]

Dear congregation! My dear brothers and sisters, who here in Europe are in pursuit of a lawful (halal) livelihood, a clean name and hearts that are not broken!

After the funeral prayer (janaza), standing before the musalla stone, all of us hear the same question: **"What was the deceased like, as you knew him? Do you release him from what he owed you?"** The congregation answers with one voice, "Helâl olsun" ("May it be released"). At that moment no one speaks of the deceased's account, title or car; only this is asked: **Is any person's right still outstanding against this brother of ours?** Let us ask ourselves the same question today, while we are still on our feet.

QUR'ANIC VERSE — An atom's weight

فَمَن يَعْمَلْ مِثْقَالَ ذَرَّةٍ خَيْرًا يَرَهُ ۝ وَمَن يَعْمَلْ مِثْقَالَ ذَرَّةٍ شَرًّا يَرَهُ

Whoever has done an atom's weight of good will see it (its recompense). And whoever has done an atom's weight of evil will see it (its recompense).

[az-Zalzala, 99:7–8]

A human being is on a journey in this worldly life. This journey begins with birth and does not end with death; death is the gate of an eternal life. This world is passing, the Hereafter lasting. For this reason the believer lives every act as a trust for which an account will be asked in the Hereafter. Our Lord tells us that nothing we do will go unrequited. A person forgets some of what they have done, and people forget wrongs in time; but nothing is hidden from Allah's knowledge.

The rights of others are the material and moral rights that people hold over one another. Taking someone's property unjustly, not paying a debt, betraying a trust, withholding a worker's labour, cheating in trade: each of these violates the material rights of others. Belittling a person, mocking, backbiting and slandering, damaging their honour and reputation: each of these violates their moral rights. So the rights of others are not only "consuming someone's money"; they are a wide responsibility that embraces all our relationships, from family life to trade, from the neighbourhood to the workplace, from friendship to social media.

Today we shall speak of the foundation of the rights of others, of their material and moral sides, and of the responsibility that rests on the tongue, on social media and on public property; we shall see the reckoning of the Hereafter in the hadith of the bankrupt, and learn the way out, settling accounts and seeking release. Our key sentence is this: **A right owed to another is not lifted until it is returned to its owner or the owner releases us from it; whoever does not settle it today will pay with their good deeds on the day when dinar and dirham are of no use.**

I. THE FOUNDATION OF THE RIGHTS OF OTHERS: THE TRUST

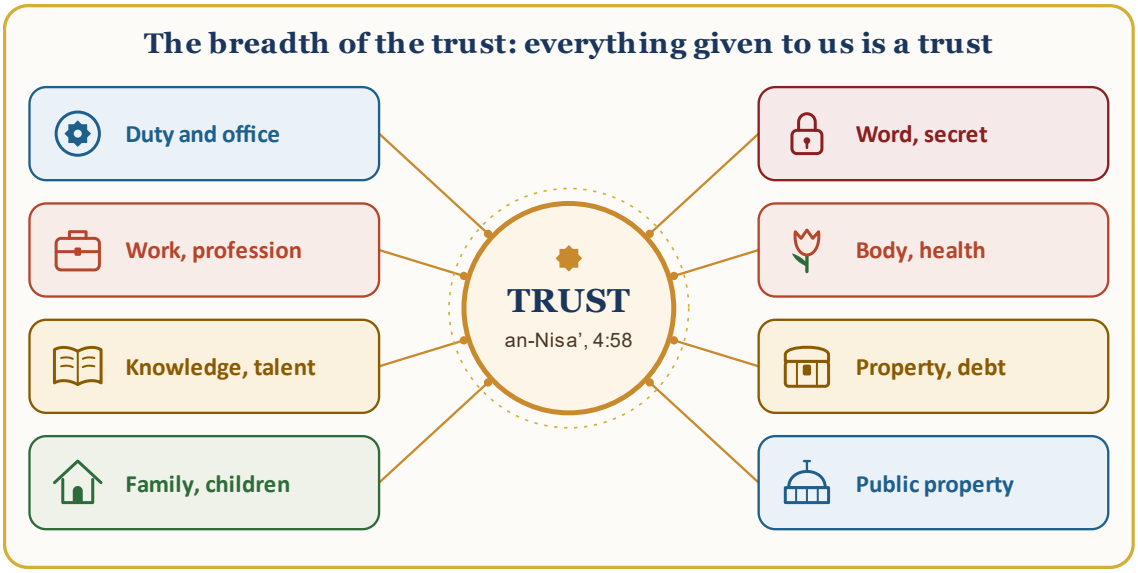
QUR'ANIC VERSE — Render trusts to those entitled to them

إِنَّ اللَّهَ يَأْمُرُكُمْ أَن تُؤَدُّوا الْأَمَانَاتِ إِلَىٰ أَهْلِهَا وَإِذَا حَكَمْتُم بَيْنَ النَّاسِ أَن تَحْكُمُوا بِالْعَدْلِ

Allah commands you to render trusts to those entitled to them, and, when you judge between people, to judge with justice.

[an-Nisa', 4:58; excerpt from the verse]

The verse shows the two pillars of the rights of others: **the trust** and **justice**. The trust is not only a belonging that someone leaves with us. Every duty, office, profession, piece of knowledge and talent given to us; our family, our health, our word and our secrets are also a trust. A person is bound to use the means given to them in a way that pleases Allah. (Kur'an Yolu, vol. 2, pp. 81–83)



The Qur'an describes the weight of the trust like this: "We offered the trust to the heavens, the earth and the mountains, but they refused to bear it and were afraid of it, and the human being bore it." (al-Ahzab, 33:72) The human being, who shouldered this burden from which even the mountains shrank, is bound to do it justice. Our Prophet also names one of the marks of the hypocrite in these words: **"When he is entrusted, he betrays."** (al-Bukhari, Iman, 24; Muslim, Iman, 107)

A LESSON FROM HISTORY — The trusts that remained in Mecca

Even the polytheists of Mecca, who tormented our Prophet and in the end drove him from his homeland, used to call him "al-Amin", the Trustworthy, and left their valuables with him. When our Prophet left his house on the night of the hijra, he left those trusts with 'Ali so that they would reach their owners, asking him to hand them over and only then to follow. 'Ali, with his own life in danger, returned the trusts to their owners one by one, and then migrated to Medina. **Even an enemy's trust is a trust.**

[The Prophet's biography (sira); TDV İslâm Ansiklopedisi, "Hicret", "Ali"; a narration from the biography, in summary]

I. (CONTINUED) JUSTICE: WANTING FOR OUR BROTHER WHAT WE WANT FOR OURSELVES

HADITH — What you wish for yourself

لا يُؤْمِنُ أَحَدُكُمْ حَتَّى يُحِبَّ لأَخِيهِ مَا يُحِبُّ لِنَفْسِهِ

According to the narration of Anas (may Allah be pleased with him), our Prophet said: "None of you has truly believed until he wants for his brother what he wants for himself."

[al-Bukhari, Iman, 7 (13); Muslim, Iman, 71 (45)]

Justice is not to be sought only in the courtroom: a father must be just towards his child, a spouse towards a spouse, an employer towards a worker, a trader towards a customer, a neighbour towards a neighbour. The measure is clear: to want for our brother what we want for ourselves. Our servanthood to Allah must also show in how we treat Allah's servants.

QUR'ANIC VERSE — Hatred towards a people

وَلَا يَجْرِمَنَّكُمْ شَنَآنُ قَوْمٍ عَلَىٰ أَلَّا تَعْدِلُوا اعْدِلُوا هُوَ أَقْرَبُ لِلتَّقْوَىٰ

Let not hatred for any people lead you to act unjustly. Be just; that is closer to taqwa (piety).

[al-Ma'ida, 5:8; excerpt from the verse]

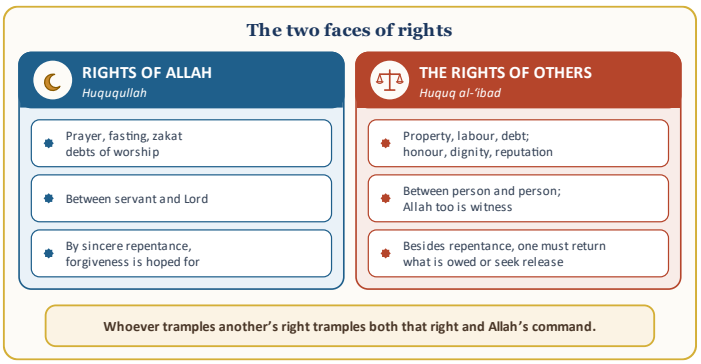
This measure does not hold only among Muslims. The right of our Belgian neighbour, of our employer, of our landlord, even of the state, is also a right; the verse says that not even hatred can be an excuse for injustice. **The rights of others recognise no religion, language or colour.** When our Prophet passed away, even his armour was pledged with a Jewish man against a debt of barley. (al-Bukhari, Jihad, 89 (2916))

HADITH — I have forbidden wrongdoing

يَا عِبَادِي إِنِّي حَرَّمْتُ الظُّلْمَ عَلَى نَفْسِي وَجَعَلْتُهُ بَيْنَكُمْ مُحَرَّمًا فَلَا تَظَالَمُوا

According to Abu Dharr (may Allah be pleased with him), who reports from our Prophet, who reports from his Lord, Allah says: "O My servants! I have forbidden wrongdoing for Myself, and I have made it forbidden among you as well; so do not wrong one another."

[Muslim, Birr, 55 (2577); hadith qudsi (sacred hadith)]



Failings against Allah are hoped to be forgiven through sincere repentance; a right of another person, by contrast, lapses only by being paid to its owner or by obtaining the owner's consent. The conditions of repentance are to abandon the sin, to feel regret and to resolve not to return to it; if the sin is a violation of another person's right, one must also return what is owed or ask for release (helallik). (DİA, "Kul Hakkı", "Tövbe")

II. MATERIAL RIGHTS OF OTHERS: PROPERTY AND TRADE

QUR'ANIC VERSE — Do not consume your wealth unjustly

وَلَا تَأْكُلُوا أَمْوَالَكُم بَيْنَكُم بِالْبَاطِلِ

Do not consume your wealth among yourselves unjustly.

[al-Baqara, 2:188; excerpt from the verse]

The material rights of others show themselves most plainly in property: taking property unjustly, not paying a debt, not handing back a trust, underpaying a worker, hiding the defect in defective goods. The Qur'an draws particular attention to injustice in measure and weight:

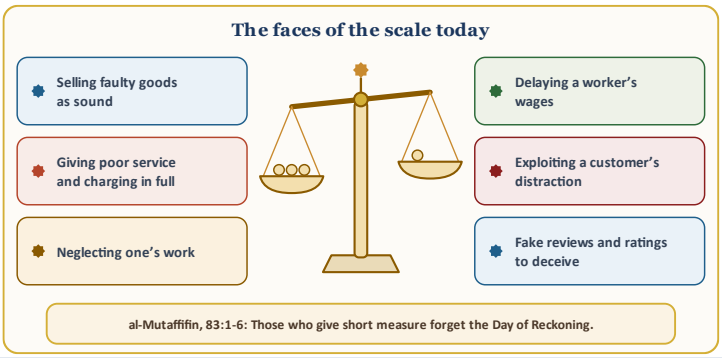
QUR'ANIC VERSE — Woe to those who give short measure

وَيْلٌ لِّلْمُطَفِّفِينَ ۝ الَّذِينَ إِذَا اكْتَالُوا عَلَى النَّاسِ يَسْتَوْفُونَ ۝ وَإِذَا كَالُوهُمْ أَو وَّزَنُوهُمْ يُخْسِرُونَ

Woe to those who give short measure! Those who, when they take a measure from people, take it in full; but when they measure or weigh for others, they give less (they diminish).

[al-Mutaffifin, 83:1–3]

Right after the warning the Day of the Hereafter is recalled: "Do they not think that they will be raised up for that great Day — the Day when people will stand before the Lord of the worlds?" (al-Mutaffifin, 83:4–6) So injustice in trade is a responsibility for which an account will be given in the Hereafter. (Kur'an Yolu, vol. 5, pp. 573–574)



HADITH — The wet grain

أَفَلاَ جَعَلْتَهُ فَوْقَ الطَّعَامِ كَيْ يَرَاهُ النَّاسُ مَنْ غَشَّ فَلَيْسَ مِنِّي

Abu Hurayra (may Allah be pleased with him) reports: The Messenger of Allah put his hand into a heap of wheat, and his fingers became wet. "Owner of the food, what is this?" he asked. When the man said, "The rain wetted it," he said: "Then why did you not put it on top of the food, so that people could see it? ***Whoever deceives is not one of us.***"

[Muslim, Iman, 164 (102)]

Let us not look for the measure only on the scale: selling faulty goods as sound, charging the full fee for deficient service and deceiving with false reviews also spoil the measure. The believer's question is not only "How much did I earn?" but **"Is my earning lawful (halal)?"** Taking advantage of the distraction of one of our brothers or sisters also falls, in conscience, under the rights of others.

II. (CONTINUED) DEBT AND THE SWEAT OF ONE'S BROW

HADITH — The wealthy person who delays repaying a debt

مَطْلُ الْغَنِيِّ ظُلْمٌ

According to the narration of Abu Hurayra (may Allah be pleased with him), our Prophet said: "For a person who has the means, to put off repaying a debt is wrongdoing."

[al-Bukhari, Hawalat, 1 (2287); Muslim, Musaqat, 33 (1564)]

Debt is a right that is made light of in this world but weighs heavily in the Hereafter. Our Prophet said: **"The soul of the believer remains bound to its debt until it is paid."** (al-Tirmidhi, Janaiz, 76 (1078)) He declared that even a martyr's sins are all forgiven except debt. (Muslim, Imara, 119 (1886)) At the funeral of a man in debt, he first said, "Pray over your companion yourselves," and led the prayer himself only after Abu Qatada took the debt upon himself. (al-Bukhari, Kafala, 3 (2295)) On the other hand, Allah makes it easy to repay for the one who borrows with the intention of repaying. (al-Bukhari, Istiqrad, 2 (2387)) **Saying "He has surely forgotten it by now" is no excuse in the Hereafter.**

HADITH — I am the adversary of three

قَالَ اللَّهُ ثَلاَثَةٌ أَنَا خَصْمُهُمْ يَوْمَ الْقِيَامَةِ، رَجُلٌ أَعْطَى بِي ثُمَّ غَدَرَ، وَرَجُلٌ بَاعَ حُرًّا فَأَكَلَ ثَمَنَهُ، وَرَجُلٌ اسْتَأْجَرَ أَجِيرًا فَاسْتَوْفَى مِنْهُ، وَلَمْ يُعْطِ أَجْرَهُ

Abu Hurayra (may Allah be pleased with him) reports: Allah said: "There are three people against whom I shall stand as adversary on the Day of Resurrection: one who gives his word in My name and then breaks it; one who sells a free person and consumes the price; and one who hires a worker, has the work fully done, and then does not pay the wage."

[al-Bukhari, Buyu', 106 (2227); Ijara, 10 (2270); hadith qudsi]

A worker's wage is also a right of another: the employer must pay wages on time and in full. It is narrated that our Prophet said, "Pay the worker his wage before his sweat dries"; the chain of this narration contains weakness, but its meaning is supported by other authentic narrations. (Ibn Majah, Ruhun, 4 (2443)) The worker, too, must do the job properly; doing justice to the wage one receives is also a responsibility.

A LESSON FROM HISTORY — A thousand dinars and the sea

Our Prophet tells of a man from the Children of Israel: the man asked another for a thousand dinars as a loan. When the lender said, "Bring witnesses," he said, "Allah is enough as a witness"; when he said, "Then bring a guarantor," he said, "Allah is enough as a guarantor." The lender said, "You have spoken the truth," and gave him the money for a fixed term. The man crossed the sea and attended to his business; when the term came, he looked for a ship to pay his debt but could not find one. So he hollowed out a log, put the thousand dinars and a letter to the lender inside, and sealed it; he came to the sea and said, "O Allah! You know that I borrowed a thousand dinars from so-and-so. He asked for a guarantor, and I said, 'Allah is enough as a guarantor,' and he accepted You. I did my utmost to find a ship to get his money to him, but I could not find one; now I entrust it to You," and he cast the log into the sea. The lender, too, had gone out to the shore to see whether a ship was bringing his money; he picked up the log as firewood for his family, and when he split it, he found the money and the letter. Then the debtor came with a thousand dinars and said, "By Allah, I did not stop searching for a ship to bring you your money." The lender said, "Allah delivered to me on your behalf what you sent in the log; take your thousand dinars and go well." **A word given with Allah as guarantor and witness crosses the seas.**

[al-Bukhari, Kafala, 1 (2291; mu'allaq, introduced with "al-Layth said"); connected chain: Ahmad ibn Hanbal, al-Musnad; in summary]

III. MORAL RIGHTS OF OTHERS: WRONGS WE COMMIT WITH OUR TONGUE

The rights of others begin not only in the wallet but also on the tongue. In his Farewell Sermon our Prophet said: **"(O people!) Just as this (Dhu'l-Hijja) month of yours, in this (Mecca) city of yours, on this ('Arafa) day of yours is sacred, so too are your blood, your property and your honour (dignity and chastity) sacred."** (al-Bukhari, 'Ilm, 9; Muslim, Qasama, 30)

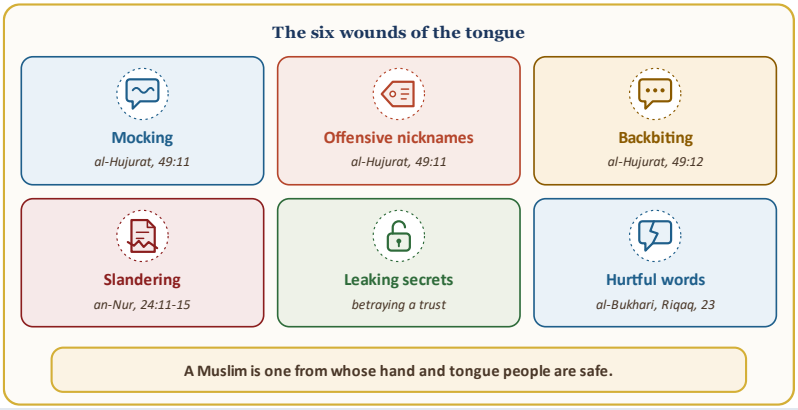
QUR'ANIC VERSE — Do not mock one another

لَا يَسْخَرْ قَوْمٌ مِّن قَوْمٍ عَسَىٰ أَن يَكُونُوا خَيْرًا مِّنْهُمْ وَلَا نِسَاءٌ مِّن نِّسَاءٍ عَسَىٰ أَن يَكُنَّ خَيْرًا مِّنْهُنَّ وَلَا تَلْمِزُوا أَنفُسَكُمْ وَلَا تَنَابَزُوا بِالْأَلْقَابِ

Let no people ridicule another people, for they may be better than they. Nor let women ridicule other women, for those ridiculed may be better than those who ridicule. Do not belittle one another, and do not call one another by offensive names.

[al-Hujurat, 49:11; excerpt from the verse]

The verse shows the place of human honour and dignity in Islamic ethics. (Kur'an Yolu, vol. 5, pp. 94–95) Without touching a person's property we can still violate their right: with a word we can break their heart, with gossip cause unrest in their family, with a slander bring about harm that lasts for years, and by telling a secret destroy their trust. **Guarding our tongue is among the most important ways of protecting ourselves from violating the rights of others.**



HADITH — The one from whose hand and tongue people are safe

الْمُسْلِمُ مَنْ سَلِمَ الْمُسْلِمُونَ مِنْ لِسَانِهِ وَيَدِهِ وَالْمُؤْمِنُ مَنْ أَمِنَهُ النَّاسُ عَلَى دِمَائِهِمْ وَأَمْوَالِهِمْ

According to the narration of Abu Hurayra (may Allah be pleased with him), our Prophet said: "A Muslim is one from whose hand and tongue other Muslims are safe. A believer is one whom people trust with their lives and their property."

[al-Tirmidhi, Iman, 12 (2627); al-Nasa'i, Iman, 8; the first sentence: al-Bukhari, Iman, 4 (10); Muslim, Iman, 65 (41)]

The tongue can both raise a person and bring them down. Our Prophet tells us that a servant may fall into Hell because of a careless word that earns Allah's wrath, and may rise in rank with Allah through a good word spoken just as carelessly. (al-Bukhari, Riqaq, 23 (6478)) So our measure is this: **"Whoever believes in Allah and the Last Day, let him say what is good or else keep silent."** (al-Bukhari, Adab, 31 (6018); Muslim, Iman, 74 (47))

III. (CONTINUED) BACKBITING AND SLANDER

QUR'ANIC VERSE — The flesh of a dead brother

وَلَا يَغْتَب بَّعْضُكُم بَعْضًا أَيُحِبُّ أَحَدُكُمْ أَن يَأْكُلَ لَحْمَ أَخِيهِ مَيْتًا فَكَرِهْتُمُوهُ

Do not backbite one another. Would any of you like to eat the flesh of his dead brother? You would loathe it!

[al-Hujurat, 49:12; excerpt from the verse]

HADITH — What is backbiting?

أَتَدْرُونَ مَا الْغِيبَةُ قَالُوا اللَّهُ وَرَسُولُهُ أَعْلَمُ قَالَ ذِكْرُكَ أَخَاكَ بِمَا يَكْرَهُ قِيلَ أَفَرَأَيْتَ إِنْ كَانَ فِي أَخِي مَا أَقُولُ قَالَ إِنْ كَانَ فِيهِ مَا تَقُولُ فَقَدِ اغْتَبْتَهُ وَإِنْ لَمْ يَكُنْ فِيهِ فَقَدْ بَهَتَّهُ

*Abu Hurayra (may Allah be pleased with him) reports: The Messenger of Allah asked, "Do you know what backbiting is?" The Companions said, "Allah and His Messenger know best." He said, "It is to mention your brother with something he dislikes." Someone asked, "What if what I say is actually true of my brother?" He replied, "If what you say is true of him, you have backbitten him; and if it is not, you have **slandered** him."*

[Muslim, Birr, 70 (2589)]

Backbiting is often committed with the words "but I am telling the truth"; our Prophet answered this objection: if the fault mentioned is in the person, it is backbiting; if not, it is **buhtan**, that is, slander. On the night of the Mi'raj our Prophet came upon a group who were tearing at their faces and chests with nails of copper; Gabriel said, "These are the ones who eat people's flesh and attack their honour and dignity." (Abu Dawud, Adab, 35 (4878))

QUR'ANIC VERSE — The ifk: when you heard that slander

لَّوْلَا إِذْ سَمِعْتُمُوهُ ظَنَّ الْمُؤْمِنُونَ وَالْمُؤْمِنَاتُ بِأَنفُسِهِمْ خَيْرًا وَقَالُوا هَٰذَا إِفْكٌ مُّبِينٌ

When you heard it, should not the believing men and women have thought well of one another and said, "This is a clear slander"?

[an-Nur, 24:12]

The Qur'an recounts the gravest example of slander in the incident of the ifk: "Those who brought forth the slander are a group among you… Each of them will bear the sin he has earned; and for the one among them who took upon himself the greater part of it, there is a great punishment." (an-Nur, 24:11) This slander cast against our mother 'A'isha (may Allah be pleased with her) harmed not only her but also the household of our Prophet and the climate of trust in society. The verses also condemn passing slander from tongue to tongue: "You passed it on with your tongues and spoke with your mouths what you had no knowledge of; you thought it a small matter, while with Allah it is a grave one." (an-Nur, 24:15) A baseless word can affect a person's family, work and reputation for years. That is why slander is likened to a murder committed with the tongue.

IV. THE RIGHTS OF OTHERS APPLY ON SOCIAL MEDIA TOO

> 🕯 ***Dear brothers and sisters! Especially our young people, whose phones never leave their hands, our dear children!***

In our age we meet new faces of the rights of others: sharing a person's photo without permission, spreading a piece of information about their private life, passing on news whose truth has not been checked, insulting people in comments, circulating images that humiliate someone: these are serious responsibilities. A change of medium does not change responsibility: what we would not say to someone's face, let us not say in a comment either.

📖 **QUR'ANIC VERSE — Verify the news**

يَا أَيُّهَا الَّذِينَ آمَنُوا إِن جَاءَكُمْ فَاسِقٌ بِنَبَإٍ فَتَبَيَّنُوا أَن تُصِيبُوا قَوْمًا بِجَهَالَةٍ فَتُصْبِحُوا عَلَىٰ مَا فَعَلْتُمْ نَادِمِينَ

So that you do not harm people unknowingly and then regret what you have done, when a transgressor brings you news, verify it.

[al-Hujurat, 49:6]

According to what the commentators report, this verse was revealed when the official sent to collect zakat from the Banu Mustaliq turned back before reaching the tribe and brought the unfounded report that they refused to pay zakat; when the report was investigated, it proved untrue. (Kur'an Yolu, al-Hujurat 49:6) Our Prophet also said: **"It is enough lying for a person to relate everything he hears."** (Muslim, Muqaddima, 5; Abu Dawud, Adab, 80) The fatwa sources likewise ask that privacy, accurate information and avoidance of slander, backbiting and prying be respected in online spaces. **A lie that is shared is a violation of the rights of others that multiplies with the number of those who share it.**



📖 **QUR'ANIC VERSE — Every word spoken is recorded**

مَّا يَلْفِظُ مِن قَوْلٍ إِلَّا لَدَيْهِ رَقِيبٌ عَتِيدٌ

He utters not a word without a most attentive watcher beside him!

[Qaf, 50:18]

The same measure applies to our own posts: insults in the comments, children's photos posted without permission, a secret or a fault spread in family WhatsApp groups… The Qur'an warns: "Do not pursue what you have no knowledge of! Surely hearing, sight and the heart, all of these will be questioned about it." (al-Isra', 17:36) **Even behind a phone screen, Allah sees us.**

V. TRUE BANKRUPTCY IN THE HEREAFTER: THE HADITH OF THE BANKRUPT

The hadith that describes most strikingly the weight of the rights of others in the Hereafter is the hadith of the bankrupt.

HADITH — Do you know who the bankrupt is?

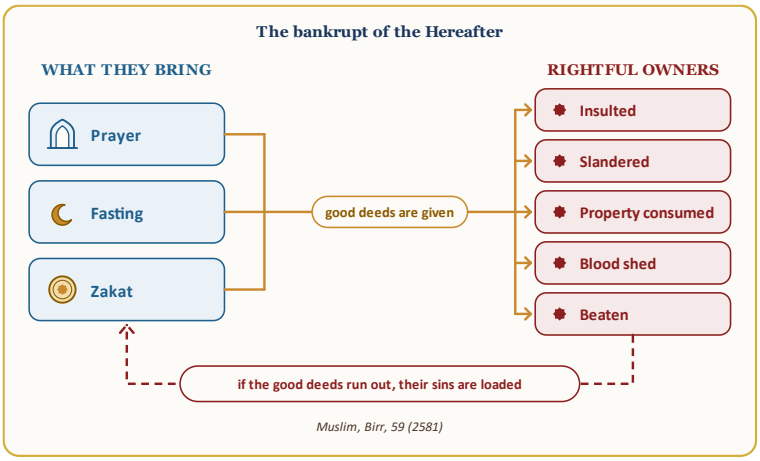
أَتَدْرُونَ مَا الْمُفْلِسُ

قَالُوا الْمُفْلِسُ فِينَا مَنْ لاَ دِرْهَمَ لَهُ وَلاَ مَتَاعَ

إِنَّ الْمُفْلِسَ مِنْ أُمَّتِي يَأْتِي يَوْمَ الْقِيَامَةِ بِصَلاَةٍ وَصِيَامٍ وَزَكَاةٍ

Abu Hurayra (may Allah be pleased with him) reports: The Messenger of Allah asked, "Do you know who the bankrupt is?" The Companions said, "For us the bankrupt is the one who has no money or goods." Our Prophet then said: "The bankrupt of my community is the one who comes on the Day of Resurrection with prayer, fasting and zakat, but who has also insulted this one, slandered that one, consumed the property of another, shed the blood of another and beaten another. The reward of his good deeds is given to this one and that one. If his good deeds run out before the rights owed by him are paid, some of the sins of those entitled are taken and placed on him; then he is thrown into Hell."

[Muslim, Birr, 59 (2581); al-Tirmidhi, Qiyama, 2 (2418)]



A person may pray, fast and give zakat; but if they wrong people, take their property unjustly or hurt them with the tongue, they face a great danger in the Hereafter. Acts of worship are not worthless; but they must make a person upright and just: prayer should keep us from evil, fasting should strengthen the will and zakat generosity, and the Qur'an should teach justice and compassion.

HADITH — The right of the hornless sheep

لَتُؤَدُّنَّ الْحُقُوقَ إِلَى أَهْلِهَا يَوْمَ الْقِيَامَةِ حَتَّى يُقَادَ لِلشَّاةِ الْجَلْحَاءِ مِنَ الشَّاةِ الْقَرْنَاءِ

According to the narration of Abu Hurayra (may Allah be pleased with him), our Prophet said: "On the Day of Resurrection rights will certainly be returned to their owners, so that even the hornless sheep will have its right taken from the horned sheep."

[Muslim, Birr, 60 (2582)]

On a day when rights are observed even among animals, the wrong done by one person to another is not forgotten. **A debt that could be paid today with a wallet will be paid there with prayers, fasts and zakat.**

VI. THE RIGHTS OF OTHERS IN THE FAMILY, THE NEIGHBOURHOOD AND WORKING LIFE

Most often we violate the rights of those closest to us: saying “after all, it is family,” we make light of the rights of our spouse, our children, our parents and our siblings. Yet **a right does not lapse through closeness:** being a sibling does not permit taking property unjustly, being a spouse does not permit wrongdoing, being a child does not permit breaking someone’s dignity.

HADITH — Be just among your children

فَاتَّقُوا اللَّهَ، وَاعْدِلُوا بَيْنَ أَوْلاَدِكُمْ

*al-Nu‘man ibn Bashir (may Allah be pleased with him) reports: His father wanted to give him a gift, and his mother had asked that our Prophet be a witness. Our Prophet asked, “Have you given all your other children the like of this?” When the answer was “No,” he said, **“Fear Allah, and be just among your children.”** In Muslim’s version he also says, “Then do not make me a witness; I do not bear witness to injustice.”*

[al-Bukhari, Hiba, 13 (2587); Muslim, Hibat (1623)]

Favouring one child unjustly leads to jealousy and hurt among siblings and damages the child’s dignity; that is, it gives rise to a violation of the rights of others within the family.

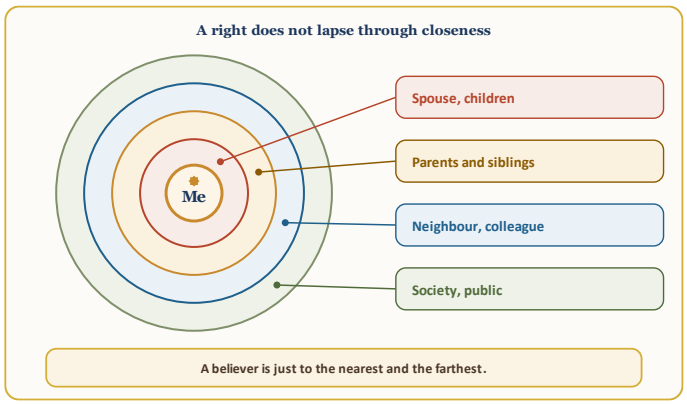
QUR’ANIC VERSE — Men have a share, and so do women

لِّلرِّجَالِ نَصِيبٌ مِّمَّا تَرَكَ الْوَالِدَانِ وَالْأَقْرَبُونَ وَلِلنِّسَاءِ نَصِيبٌ مِّمَّا تَرَكَ الْوَالِدَانِ وَالْأَقْرَبُونَ مِمَّا قَلَّ مِنْهُ أَوْ كَثُرَ نَصِيبًا مَّفْرُوضًا

For men there is a share of what parents and relatives leave; and for women there is a share of what parents and relatives leave, be it little or much — a fixed share.

[an-Nisa’, 4:7]

A wrong frequently met with here in Europe is inheritance: the field, house or shop back in the home country; sisters talked out of their share with the words “You married; your share is in your husband’s house”; “voluntary” signatures obtained through shame or pressure. Allah Himself has fixed the shares and has called them “the limits set by Allah.” (an-Nisa’, 4:13) **To deprive a sister of her share without her free consent is a violation of the rights of others committed against those closest to us.**



The neighbour’s right is also our responsibility. Our Prophet said three times, “By Allah, he does not believe!” and when asked, “Who, O Messenger of Allah?” he said, “The one whose neighbour is not safe from his harm!” (al-Bukhari, Adab, 29 (6016)) Noise at night, parking that blocks the neighbour’s door, leaving shared areas neglected: these fall under this right. At work, neglecting one’s hours, obtaining a sick note one has not earned, using the employer’s materials for private jobs are also violations of the rights of others. **“Each of you is a shepherd, and each of you is responsible for those in your charge.”** (al-Bukhari, Jumu‘a, 11 (893); Muslim, Imara, 20 (1829))

VII. PUBLIC RIGHT: THE TRUST THOUGHT TO HAVE NO OWNER

QUR'ANIC VERSE — No prophet misappropriates

وَمَا كَانَ لِنَبِيٍّ أَن يَغُلَّ وَمَن يَغْلُلْ يَأْتِ بِمَا غَلَّ يَوْمَ الْقِيَامَةِ

No prophet would ever misappropriate the due of those who fought. Whoever commits such an injustice will come on the Day of Resurrection carrying what he misappropriated.

[Al 'Imran, 3:161; excerpt from the verse]

HADITH — A camel groaning on his neck

لاَ أُلْفِيَنَّ أَحَدَكُمْ يَجِيءُ يَوْمَ الْقِيَامَةِ عَلَى رَقَبَتِهِ بَعِيرٌ لَهُ رُغَاءٌ يَقُولُ يَا رَسُولَ اللَّهِ أَغِثْنِي فَأَقُولُ لاَ أَمْلِكُ لَكَ شَيْئًا قَدْ أَبْلَغْتُكَ

Abu Hurayra (may Allah be pleased with him) reports: The Messenger of Allah, stressing the gravity of betrayal over the spoils of war (ghulul), said: "Let me not find any of you on the Day of Resurrection coming to me with a camel groaning on his neck, saying, 'O Messenger of Allah, help me!' and I shall say, 'I can do nothing for you; I conveyed the message to you.'"

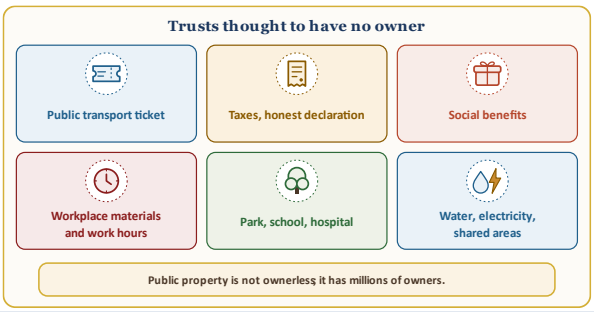
[Muslim, Imara, 24 (1831); similar narration: al-Bukhari, Jihad, 189 (3073)]

Public property is not ownerless; it is a shared trust. **Ghulul** is taking from the spoils of war without permission; using public resources for personal gain is also understood within this scope. When Ibn al-Lutbiyya, who collected zakat, said, "This was given to me as a gift," our Prophet said, "Why did he not sit in his father's house and see whether a gift would be given to him?" (al-Bukhari, Hiba, 17 (2597); Muslim, Imara, 26 (1832)) What is taken by reason of office is not a gift but ghulul — even if it is a needle. (Muslim, Imara, 30 (1833))

A LESSON FROM HISTORY — The state's candle

It is narrated that the caliph 'Umar ibn 'Abd al-'Aziz would work by the candle lit on behalf of the state for as long as he was dealing with the affairs of the Muslims, and when the work was finished he would put it out and have his own lamp lit. **The public's candle is for the public's work.**

[al-Fasawi, al-Ma'rifa wa-l-ta'rikh, I, 579]



GUIDANCE FROM FIQH — Public right here in Europe: keeping one's covenants

We came to this country with a visa, a residence permit, citizenship; this is a promise: "O you who believe! Fulfil your contracts." (al-Ma'ida, 5:1) "This is a non-Muslim country" is no excuse; evading tax, undeclared work ("zwartwerk / travail au noir"), a false declaration for benefits, travelling without a ticket and cheating an insurer mean reaching into the common right of millions. Our Prophet declared that he himself will be the claimant, on the Day of Resurrection, against anyone who wrongs a non-Muslim living under a covenant. (Abu Dawud, Kharaj, 31–33 (3052); good (hasan))

VIII. CONCLUSION: SETTLING ACCOUNTS AND SEEKING RELEASE BEFORE THE DAY WHEN DINAR AND DIRHAM ARE OF NO USE

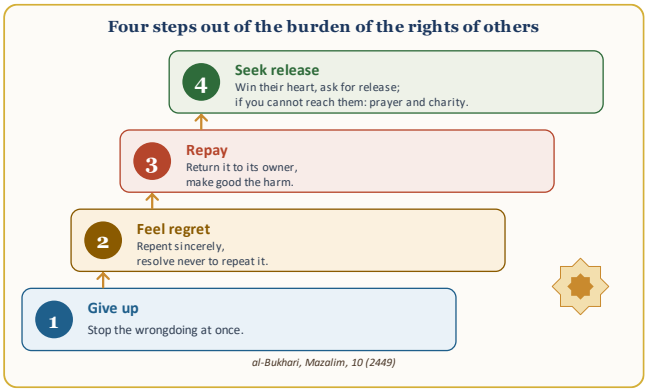
When we notice our fault, there is a way out. Our Prophet says:

HADITH — Let him settle accounts and seek release today

مَنْ كَانَتْ لَهُ مَظْلَمَةٌ لِأَخِيهِ مِنْ عِرْضِهِ أَوْ شَيْءٌ فَلْيَتَحَلَّلْهُ مِنْهُ الْيَوْمَ قَبْلَ أَنْ لَا يَكُونَ دِينَارٌ وَلَا دِرْهَمٌ

Abu Hurayra (may Allah be pleased with him) reports: Our Prophet said: "Whoever has wronged his brother in respect of his honour or his property, let him settle accounts and seek release from him today, before the day when there will be neither dinar nor dirham. Otherwise, in proportion to his wrongdoing, some of his good deeds will be taken and given to the one he wronged; and if he has no good deeds, some of the other's sins will be taken and placed on him."

[al-Bukhari, Mazalim, 10 (2449)]



First we must give up the wrong, feel regret and return what is owed: give back the property, pay the debt, make good the damage, make up the underpaid wage, and apologise to the heart we have broken. If the owner has died, the right is handed to the heirs; if the owner cannot be reached, its value is given to the poor on the owner's behalf; in the case of backbiting, where this is not possible, there are repentance, a good prayer and good deeds done on the person's behalf. The details are in the guide on page 15.

THE PLEDGE OF SETTLING ACCOUNTS AND SEEKING RELEASE — let us keep it in our wallets and hang it on the inside of our doors	
1	**I will write down my debt and pay it on time.** If I cannot pay, I will go to my creditor without running away, explain the situation and ask for a new deadline.
2	**I will keep my scale, my invoice and my word true.** I will state the defect of goods, not hide the deficiency of a service, and not take advantage of a customer's distraction.
3	**I will pay wages before the sweat of the brow has dried, and do justice to the wage I receive.** I will not delay my worker's wage, and I will not neglect my working hours and my work.
4	**I will not speak behind people's backs, and I will not share what I hear without verifying it.** I will gently warn a gathering where backbiting is going on, and I will not spread photos or secrets without permission.
5	**I will be just in my home.** I will treat my spouse and children equally and with affection, and give my sisters their inheritance rights in full.
6	**I will regard public property as a trust.** I will validate my ticket, make my declaration truthfully, and not take assistance I do not deserve.
7	**This week I will settle accounts and seek release with one person.** I will win back a heart I have broken, pay a debt I had forgotten, and call a relative with whom I have fallen out.

A right owed to another is not lifted until it is returned to its owner or the owner releases us from it; whoever does not settle it today will pay with their good deeds on the day when dinar and dirham are of no use. As we leave this Friday prayer, let us ask three questions: **Whose right is on me? Whose heart have I broken? Whose debt have I forgotten?** Let us call the first name that comes to mind today.

THE PULPIT'S CLOSING HERE IN EUROPE AND THE CONGREGATION'S SUPPLICATION

My dear brothers and sisters! Let us open our hands and our hearts to our Lord.

SUPPLICATION — Seeking refuge, praise and blessings

أَعُوذُ بِاللَّهِ مِنَ الشَّيْطَانِ الرَّجِيمِ

الْحَمْدُ لِلَّهِ رَبِّ الْعَالَمِينَ، وَالصَّلَاةُ وَالسَّلَامُ عَلَى رَسُولِنَا مُحَمَّدٍ وَعَلَى آلِهِ وَصَحْبِهِ أَجْمَعِينَ

I seek refuge in Allah from the accursed Satan. Praise belongs to Allah, Lord of the worlds. Blessings and peace be upon our Prophet Muhammad, upon his family and upon all his Companions.

[Praise: al-Fatiha, 1:2. Seeking refuge and blessings: free wording of the supplication]

SUPPLICATION — Forgive on the Day of Reckoning; leave no ill will in our hearts

رَبَّنَا اغْفِرْ لِي وَلِوَالِدَيَّ وَلِلْمُؤْمِنِينَ يَوْمَ يَقُومُ الْحِسَابُ

رَبَّنَا اغْفِرْ لَنَا وَلِإِخْوَانِنَا الَّذِينَ سَبَقُونَا بِالْإِيمَانِ وَلَا تَجْعَلْ فِي قُلُوبِنَا غِلًّا لِّلَّذِينَ آمَنُوا رَبَّنَا إِنَّكَ رَءُوفٌ رَّحِيمٌ

Our Lord! Forgive me, my mother and my father, and the believers on the Day when the account is established. — Our Lord, forgive us and our brothers who preceded us in faith, and do not leave in our hearts any ill thought or feeling towards those who believe. Our Lord! Surely You are Most Compassionate, Most Merciful.

[Ibrahim, 14:41; al-Hashr, 59:10; excerpt from the verses]

O Allah! Make us among Your servants who are mindful of the rights of others. Grant us to pay what we owe, to make good our wrongs and to mend the hearts we have broken. Make our earnings lawful, our character good, our hearts merciful. Make us among those from whose hand and tongue people are safe; protect us from being among the bankrupt in the Hereafter.

O Allah! Have mercy on those of our first generation who founded this mosque and have passed on to the Hereafter; grant health to those who are alive. Bring ease to our debtors, healing to our sick, help to the oppressed; reconcile the hearts of our brothers and sisters who have fallen out. Make our children people who remember You in their own languages too and who take no one's right.

Rabbana atina fi'd-dunya hasanatan wa fi'l-akhirati hasanatan wa qina 'adhab an-nar: "Our Lord! Give us good in this world and good in the Hereafter, and protect us from the punishment of the Fire!" (al-Baqara, 2:201) Amen. Wa'l-hamdu li-llahi rabbi'l-'alamin. **Al-Fatiha.**

NOTE FOR THE PREACHER — Method of sources

The wording of the verses is based on the Tanzil text, and the meanings on the Kur'an Yolu translation; hadith numbers follow the common numbering; the definitions of concepts have been compared with TDV İslâm Ansiklopedisi.

APPENDIX: GUIDE TO SETTLING ACCOUNTS AND SEEKING RELEASE — THE RIGHTS OF OTHERS IN QUESTIONS

Short answers to the questions the congregation asks most often are given below. These are general principles; in personal situations one should consult the imam of our community.

THE RIGHTS OF OTHERS IN QUESTIONS

Question	Guidance	Source
The owner has died; what should I do?	The right is handed over to the heirs, and release is asked of them too.	Fatwa sources; DİA, "Tövbe"
I cannot find the owner.	We search as far as we are able; if the owner cannot be reached, we give the property or its value on their behalf to the poor or to charities, and we repent sincerely. If the owner turns up, we intend to pay.	Fatwa sources; DİA, "Tövbe"
Should I tell the person I backbit?	The essential thing is to settle accounts and seek release. If that is not possible, we repent sincerely, pray well for the person and do good on their behalf. Scholars differ on this matter.	İlmihal; DİA, "Gıybet"; fatwa sources
I took something when I was a child.	If it was done before puberty, it is not counted as a sin; but the right does not lapse: if the property remains, it is returned as it is; if not, its like or its value is given to the owner; if the owner cannot be reached, charity is given on their behalf. For details the imam is consulted.	DİA, "Tövbe"; fatwa sources (general principle)
I received social benefits I did not deserve, or I have an unpaid tax debt.	Gain obtained through a false declaration is unlawful (haram); state property belongs to the people. One must correct the mistake, return what was received in excess and put the declaration right.	İlmihal; fatwa sources (general principle)
I have violated a public right, such as travelling without a ticket or using electricity illegally.	Although no specific fatwa has been found on this, the general principle applies: the price of the service used is paid to the institution concerned, and it is not repeated.	İlmihal; fatwa sources (general principle)
I do not have the means to pay my debt.	We do not run away; we explain the situation openly to the creditor and ask for a new deadline. Allah helps the one who borrows with the intention of repaying.	al-Bukhari, Istiqrad, 2 (2387)
My siblings "released" their share of the inheritance to me.	To be valid, the decision must be taken with a free and unconstrained will. A signature given out of embarrassment, pressure or custom does not remove the share. The shares fixed by Allah are definite.	an-Nisa', 4:7, 11–13; İlmihal; fatwa sources

HADITH — The account of one who dies in debt

مَنْ مَاتَ وَعَلَيْهِ دِينَارٌ أَوْ دِرْهَمٌ قُضِيَ مِنْ حَسَنَاتِهِ لَيْسَ ثَمَّ دِينَارٌ وَلَا دِرْهَمٌ

According to the narration of Ibn 'Umar (may Allah be pleased with him), our Prophet said: "Whoever dies owing a dinar or a dirham, that debt will be paid from his good deeds, for there is neither dinar nor dirham there."

[Ibn Majah, Sadaqat, 12 (2414)]

This hadith is the essence of our key sentence: the debt we make light of and postpone today will be paid there from our most precious capital, our good deeds. So instead of postponing, let us take a small step this week: a phone call, an apology, a payment.

Every day that a matter of others' rights is postponed makes it heavier. Let us get the first right we remember to its owner this week; if we cannot reach them, let us give charity on their behalf and pray. **Our Lord does not leave alone the one who intends to put a right back in its place.**